

Andrés M. Schelp

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Email: schelp@u.northwestern.edu

EDUCATION

Northwestern University Chicago, IL

Committee: Stephen C. Nelson (chair), Daniel Krmaric, Andrew Roberts,
James Mahoney

Fields: International Relations, Comparative Politics
Ph.D. in Political Science (ABD)

Expected: 2026

Master of Arts in Social Science

2023

University of San Andrés

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Master in International Political and Economic Affairs

2021

University of Buenos Aires

Buenos Aires, Argentina

BA in Political Science

2016

DISSERTATION

Title: Democratic Global Performance Indicators as upholders of a standard of society? The case of Freedom House.

Description: My dissertation project focuses on the production of global democratic standards that categorize state regime types and monitor state behavior. Despite lacking formal authority, having weak economic capacity, and no military capabilities, I argue that the power of these non-governmental ranking organizations is based on providing heuristics that help policymakers reduce uncertainty in world politics and influence targeted states' status. Therefore, if they gain legitimacy in the global arena, they can sway actors by providing categories and boundaries that determine conformity or deviation from societal standards. For my analysis, I concentrate on the influence of democratic classifications from the Freedom in the World (FITW) report by the American NGO Freedom House from 1973 to 2022. My dissertation examines how and to what extent shifting democratic credentials between states can lead to social, developmental, and diplomatic benefits or costs in the international arena. I focus on four observable implications of sanctioning or crediting: how states are talked about by others ('naming and shaming'), inclusion or outcasting from the provision of developmental benefits, observable changes in states' global democratic reputations, and diplomatic costs faced by states in agreements and treaties. Moreover, I tackle the puzzle of why states react differently after being downgraded or upgraded by Freedom House. Based on my data collection, I identified four types of responses: GPI monitoring contestation, GPI scoring contestation, GPI scoring acquiescence, and GPI adherence. By providing paired comparisons based on archival evidence, governmental and diplomatic data, and interviews with ranking and governmental officials, I present within-case evidence on the implications and rationales for their adherence or contestation.

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Democracy Rankings in Action: Social and Economic Implications of the Freedom in the World Report for U.S. foreign policy.**

(Presented at the 2025 International Studies Association Convention)

Since the end of the 20th century, many countries have incorporated information contained in global rankings, ratings, and indicators when crafting their foreign policies. However, empirical evidence about their implications is limited. To assess the relevance of democratic indicators, I focus on the Freedom in the World (FITW) report created by the American-based non-governmental organization Freedom

House in 1973. I focus on two observable implications to assess the sanctioning implications of the report: 'naming and shaming' and outcasting from developmental benefits provision. Given previous research about the relevance of the report in the U.S., I assess their influence in the Department of State annual Country Reports on Human Rights (from 1980 to 2010) and the inclusion in the African Growth and Opportunity Act (from 2001 to 2022), which provides duty-free access to the U.S. I found that democratic discrediting to the 'Not Free' category was associated with posterior increases in human rights shaming by the U.S. and a higher likelihood of outcasting from AGOA. Conversely, democratic crediting was associated with a decrease of shaming when states were upgraded to the highest Tier in the FITW report ('Free'). These results provide evidence about how global indicators credit and discredit countries' reputations, leading to observable influences on political outcomes.

2. States adherence and contestation to global democratic indicators. The role of the Freedom in the World report.

(Presented in 2024 at the APSA Annual Meeting and Northwestern University IR/CP Workshop)

Global Performance Indicators (GPIs) have become one prominent way to assess the state of democracy globally. Despite a growing research agenda on GPIs, evidence about the influence of democratic indicators is limited. This study focuses on the implications of these indicators on democratic rhetoric in both credited and discredited states. I examine the effect of democratic classifications from the Freedom in the World report by Freedom House (1973–2022) on changes in the foreign policy orientation and democratic reputation in the UN General Assembly Sessions and General Debate.

3. Eagle Eyes on the South: How does regime type shift Americans' foreign policy preferences toward the economic and political rise of semi-peripheral states?

(Presented at the 2024 International Studies Association Convention)

While emerging work has provided insights about how countries' preferences are being shaped by the rise of China, the foreign policy implications of the limited but progressive rise of semi-peripheral countries have been left mostly unexplored. In this paper, I examine how the rising performance of these countries is perceived by Americans. Also, I examine its implications for their foreign policy preferences towards them. I rely on evidence of global political and economic trends, public officials' statements, and two online experiments to gauge the foreign policy implications of the political and economic rise of semi-peripheral democracies and autocracies. Results show that the political rise of countries, rather than the economic rise, triggers more negative reactions and stronger support for U.S. retaliatory action towards rising countries. Similarly, rising democratic states are given more leniency when compared with rising autocracies, with more support for retaliatory action to prevent their rise, mostly through economic and diplomatic means.

4. Perception of relative economic growth and internationalism: Do comparison effects between countries' economic performance fuel discontent with incumbents among Europeans?

(Presented at the Summer 2023 Economy & Society Conference, and, in 2024, at the MPSA Conference, and the Northwestern Computational and Quantitative Science Workshop)

How do individuals react towards their incumbents when their states underperform in global metrics compared to their peers? I argue that given Europe's deep economic and social integration as well as economic malaise after 2008, relative economic performance considerations among European countries gained increased relevance to domestic populations. I claim that internationalist dispositions amplify international comparisons with key reference countries as benchmarks for Europeans to assess the performance of their governments and institutions. Internationalist dispositions amplify comparisons with key benchmark countries, influencing public satisfaction with governments. Relying on data from 15 European countries (2002–2019), I find that individuals' international orientations moderate the perception of economic performance gaps between European countries, negatively affecting Europeans' satisfaction with their governments.

5. Rising Prices, Elite Rhetoric, and Material Conditions: Evidence from Turkey

(Presented at the 2024 APSA Annual Meeting)

Do rhetorical frames used by politicians to deflect blame or to claim credit have any impact on public attitudes when economic times are tough? When consumer prices soar, the public's confidence in the ability of semi-authoritarian governments to competently steer the economy should collapse. However, the causes and consequences of inflation are complex, and some people may be swayed by the incumbent government's efforts to pin the blame for economic problems on misfortune (such as natural disasters and international commodity price shocks) and "bad" actors (such as domestic political opponents). A survey experiment reveals that when people are exposed to rhetorical frames that blame high inflation on international factors that are beyond the incumbent's control, they are less likely to assign full responsibility for the economic problem to the government.

PUBLICATIONS

1. 2019. [Regionalism and Democracy: A Review of Mercosur's democratic clause](#), with Lucas Chiodi and Carla Gebetsberger, *Debates Latinoamericanos* 17(35).
2. 2019. [The need to strengthen social cohesion and global governance dynamics](#), in *The G20 Agenda at the Argentine and Japan Meetings. What to expect from South Arabia G20?* Konrad Adenauer Foundation-CARI: Buenos Aires.
3. 2018. [A vision about regional contribution to a more effective global governance: the case of the multilateral international trade system](#), with Félix Peña, *Think 20 Communiqué - Global Solutions Journal*.

GRANTS

1. 2024. Minar Memorial Summer Award, Northwestern University, Department of Political Science (\$1,000).
2. 2023. Northwestern University Keyman Modern Turkish Studies Program – Research Grant (\$1,500).
3. 2022. Call on American Politics and Methods Research, Northwestern University – Research Grant (\$1,000).
4. 2022. Minar Memorial Summer Award, Northwestern University, Department of Political Science (\$500).

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

1. **Undergraduate:**
 - 1.1. 2022–2024. Northwestern University: Courses include Introduction to International Relations, Globalization, Autocracy and Democracy, International Political Economy, Political Psychology, and Drugs and Politics.
 - 1.2. 2018–2019. Argentine Catholic University: International Relations Theory.
2. **Graduate:**
 - 2.1. 2023. Northwestern University: R Workshop (3-hour workshop on text-as-data methods).
 - 2.2. 2020. Torcuato Di Tella University: Masters Thesis Seminar.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

1. 2023. For James Druckman, Northwestern University. Political Science Department Experimental Lab Manager, review of experimental designs, research projects and book manuscripts.

ACADEMIC COURSES AND SEMINARS

1. 2025. Northwestern University Political Science Department scholarship to participate in the Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR) at Syracuse University (June 15-27).

2. 2023. Summer Economy & Society Conference, hosted by Northwestern University (July 8–11, 2023).
3. 2018. Process Tracing and Multivariate Analysis Methodology Courses, Catholic University of Uruguay Winter Methods School, Montevideo, Uruguay (July 22-27).
4. 2017. "Young Argentine Leaders" scholarship from the Fulbright Commission to study and debate about U.S. domestic and foreign policy at the University of Amherst Political Science Department (June 9-27).

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Discussant:

IR Internal Workshop, Northwestern University (2024); International Studies Association Annual Convention - Social Norms and Foreign Policy Panel (2025).

Reviewer:

Revista de Relaciones Internacionales (Universidad de la Plata, Argentina).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

1. 2016-2020. **Argentine Council on International Relations**, Buenos Aires, Argentina

Academic Assistant, Academic Secretariat.

Responsibilities: Presented academic and policy reports to the academic secretariat through formal presentations and written memos. Coordinated the interaction with the heads of the institution's academic committees and workshops. Assisted and coordinated the organization of academic and policy debates events with international and domestic think tanks, domestic governmental institutions, and diplomatic representatives. Selected and guided the work of the institution's volunteers.

SPECIALIZED SKILLS

Languages: *Spanish* (native), *English* (fluent).

Software & Programming Languages: R, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics.